STRENGTH

Week 09 Strength

Week 9 of 52 | Mon 30 Nov 2026 to Sun 06 Dec 2026 | Month 2: Recovery week and checkpoint

Monday, 30 Nov Strength A - Full-body foundation (45 min)

Focus: Movement quality, tendon loading, core

Section	Details
Goblet squat	3 x 8 at 70 lb (Week 8 target 75 lb). Heels down, knees over toes, depth only as far as pain-free
Dumbbell Romanian deadlift	3 x 8 at 55 lb (Week 8 target 60 lb). Soft knees, hinge at the hip, flat back
Push-up, or dumbbell floor press if the shoulder objects	3 x 8. Pain-free only. Body in one line, elbows at 45 degrees
Single-arm dumbbell row	3 x 8 each at 70-75 lb. Pull the elbow to the hip, no torso twist. Rows are the safe direction for the shoulder
Low box jump or step-up	3 x 6. Soft, quiet landings. Skip the jump on any day the Achilles is above 2/10
Dead bug	3 x 8 each side. Low back glued to the floor
Side plank	3 x 30 s each. Hips stacked
Eccentric heel drops, straight and bent knee	3 x 12-15 each at 90 lb. Slow 3 s lowering. This is the most important exercise in the session

Notes: Warm up 5 min easy, then 10 bodyweight squats, 10 hinges, 10 arm circles. Rest 60-90 s. Fasted is fine at this length. Week 9: light. Weights down 20-30%, reps as listed.

Friday, 04 Dec Strength B - Single-leg strength (45 min)

Focus: Run durability: glute medius, patellar tracking, Achilles, adductors, lateral core. The same muscles as the band version, loaded.

Section	Details
Warm-up (5 min)	Monster walk 2 x 10 steps each way, clamshell 1 x 15 each, 10 slow bodyweight step-downs each leg. The band work is the warm-up now, not the session
Machine glute thrust	3 x 8 starting at 150 lb (Week 7 target 180-200 lb). Your Sep 20 top was 250 lb. 2 s squeeze at the top, ribs down, leave 3 reps in reserve
Bulgarian split squat, rear foot on a bench, dumbbells	3 x 8 each leg at 2 x 25 lb (Week 7 target 2 x 35 lb). Front shin near vertical, knee over the second toe, torso tall. This is the squat pattern running actually uses
Single-leg dumbbell deadlift	3 x 8 each leg at 35-40 lb. Hinge, free-side hip stays level, a hand on the rack for balance is fine. Hamstring and glute medius together
Weighted step-down from a 6-8 inch step	3 x 10 each leg holding a 20-25 lb dumbbell goblet-style. Slow 3 s lower, free heel taps the floor, knee never dives inward. Patellar tracking under load
Leg press calf raise, straight knee	3 x 15 at 180 lb (Week 7 target 200 lb). Full range, 3 s down, 30 s rest as you already do. Achilles capacity
Copenhagen plank, short lever (knee on the bench)	3 x 20 s each side. Top knee and shin on the bench, bottom leg bent, hips in line. Adductors protect the knee; build time, not lever length
Cable Pallof press	3 x 8 each side at 25-30 lb. Cable at chest height, arms long, resist the twist. Add 5 lb when 12 feel easy
Suitcase carry	3 x 40 m each hand with a 50-70 lb dumbbell. Walk tall, shoulders level, no lean. Lateral core under real load; the finisher you will enjoy

Notes: Rebuilt 29 Oct 2026 from your end-of-October comments: the band version felt like accessory work. Every stride lands about 2.5 x bodyweight on one leg; this session is what makes that safe. Rest 60-90 s, nothing to failure, own day with no run before it. Week 9: light. Weights down 20-30%, keep the calf raises at full volume.